



INGREDIENTS

- 1kg (2¼lb) butternut squash
- 2 medium carrots, approximately 200g (7oz)

- 1 orange pepper, de-seeded and chopped
- 1 tbsp vegetable oil
- 1 onion, roughly chopped
- 1 litre (1¾ pint) vegetable stock
- Toasted pumpkin seeds (optional)



Put your back into it guys!



1 PREHEAT THE OVEN to 200°C (400°F/Gas 6). Cut the butternut squash in half lengthways and scoop out the seeds and pith from the centre.



2 CAREFULLY REMOVE the skin with a peeler. Cut the squash into small cubes about 2cm (¾in) in size. Peel and roughly chop the carrots.



3 PLACE THE PEPPER, carrots, and squash cubes in a roasting tray and drizzle oil on top. Season with salt and pepper, then roast for 20 minutes.



4 REMOVE FROM THE OVEN and add the onion. Return the baking tray to the oven for a further 15 minutes. Remove and allow to cool slightly.



5 PLACE THE VEGETABLES and half the stock in a food processor and blend until smooth. Or you can mash the squash with a potato masher.



6 POUR THE MIXTURE back into a saucepan, add the rest of the stock and simmer for 3–4 minutes until hot. Serve with a sprinkling of pumpkin seeds on top.